

FOI GREEN

A Guide to Sustainable Life
at UNIZG FOI

Small Choices. **Big Impact.**



Strengthening the
ecosystem for
sustainable student
mobility

Co-funded by the
Erasmus+ Programme
of the European Union



foiProjects:

IMPRESSUM

PUBLICATION TITLE:

FOI GREEN - A Guide to Sustainable Life at UNIZG FOI

PUBLISHER:

University of Zagreb Faculty of Organization and Informatics

FOR THE PUBLISHER:

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GRAPHICS:

Canva

PHOTOS:

[FOI.UNIZG](#) (Flickr)

YEAR OF PUBLICATION:

2026

FORMAT:

Digital publication

VERSION OF PUBLICATION:

Version 2.0 (September, 2026)

This booklet was developed at the University of Zagreb Faculty of Organization and Informatics as part of the Erasmus+ project **Strengthening the Ecosystem for Sustainable Student Mobility - SuMoS** (Erasmus+ programme - KA220-HED - Cooperation partnerships in higher education, 2024-1-HR01-KA220-HED-000254853), through the joint efforts of the **SuMoS project team and FOI's Center for Projects**.



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INTRODUCTION

Sustainability is part of everyday life at the University of Zagreb Faculty of Organization and Informatics (UNIZG FOI): how we study and work, travel, use resources and connect with the community.

FOI promotes responsible choices through teaching and learning, research, projects, campus practices, digital transformation and cooperation with local and international partners.

This guide brings together existing FOI practices, relevant European guidance and insights from the Erasmus+ SuMoS project. It is intended for students, staff and the wider FOI community and presents practical ideas that can also be applied at home, at work, around the city and while travelling. Explore the practices, choose what works for you, take small steps and share useful ideas with others.

This guide builds on the sustainability goals of the Erasmus+ project SuMoS – Strengthening the Ecosystem for Sustainable Student Mobility, particularly its focus on green practices and raising individual and institutional environmental awareness. It extends these principles beyond student mobility, connecting them with everyday choices and practices that contribute to a more sustainable academic community.



AWARENESS & MOTIVATIONS

Sustainable development is a shared responsibility of governments, businesses, cities, communities, organizations and individuals. Higher education institutions have a special role because they connect education, research, innovation, institutional practice and engagement with society.

At UNIZG FOI, this role is reflected in several areas:

Teaching and learning

FOI integrates sustainability topics into education and gives students opportunities to develop knowledge, skills and perspectives for environmental, social and economic challenges.

Research and innovation

Research, projects and digital innovation contribute to developing and testing solutions for more sustainable organizations, communities and ways of living and working.

FOI premises and responsible institutional practices

FOI addresses energy and resource use, waste separation, digitalization, mobility and long-term infrastructure planning. The new UNIZG FOI Campus, planned for completion in 2028, is conceived as a modern, energy-efficient environment based on green-transition principles, with renewable energy, smart energy management and sustainable design.

Partnerships and engagement

FOI works with local and international partners, public institutions, organizations and the wider community to exchange knowledge, develop initiatives and support change beyond campus.

People and community

FOI is primarily its students, staff, partners and surrounding community. Each can contribute through everyday choices, academic and professional activities, participation, ideas and collaboration. This guide helps the community discover existing practices, get involved and propose new ideas.



UNIZG FOI is not only its buildings, strategies or institutional practices. FOI is primarily its students, staff, partners and the community around it.



In line with its sustainable surrounding

The city of Varaždin, where UNIZG FOI is located, is known as the city of music, flowers, parks, and bicycles. Being a home to about 40,000 residents and with an average temperature of 10°C, Varaždin is one of Croatia's most appealing places to live or visit. It serves as the cultural, economic, educational and sports hub of north-western Croatia.

In 2025, Varaždin has earned the Green Destinations Silver Award, becoming the first major Croatian city to reach this level of international sustainability recognition. This reward is confirming the strength of its environmental, cultural and social sustainability efforts and achievements in heritage preservation, waste management, energy efficiency and climate adaptation.



Rooted in tradition.



Inspired by the future.

GREEN HABITS

Sustainability starts with everyday choices.

Sustainability starts with the everyday choices. UNIZG FOI encourages students, staff and partners to adopt simple habits that reduce their negative environmental impact to contribute to a greener community. These recommendations range from saving energy and water, reducing waste, using resources responsibly, choosing sustainable transport, reducing digital waste, to taking part in volunteering and sustainability initiatives. Small changes can make a meaningful difference. Discover what you can do, turn awareness into action, and share your ideas to inspire positive change across the community.

THE GUIDE FOLLOWS THREE SIMPLE STEPS:

1. Discover

Look around. Listen. Learn.

2. Get Involved

Turn awareness into everyday action.

3. Make a Difference

Bring forward ideas and help shape a greener community.





DISCOVER

Sustainability is already part of everyday life at FOI.

Students encounter it through courses and assignments, projects, competitions and challenges, workshops and events, international programmes, volunteering, digital transformation, mobility, resource use and campus infrastructure.

Sustainability-related topics appear in courses such as Digital Transformation, Organizational Behavior and Organizational Performance Measurement, as well as initiatives such as the Global Goals Jam. FOI also connects sustainability with World Environment Day, Principles for Responsible Management Education, UN Global Compact, circular economy and sustainable business models, green regeneration and digital solutions.



These activities connect students, staff, partner organizations and the local community.

READ AND EXPLORE MORE

FOI's sustainability efforts are guided by a broader framework of global, European, national and institutional strategies and initiatives. These documents provide the policy context for sustainable development, green transition, responsible resource use, climate action and education for sustainability.

Global and European



- [Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development](#)
- [United Nations Sustainable Development Goals \(SDGs\)](#)
- [Paris Agreement](#)
- [UNESCO – Education for Sustainable Development: A Roadmap – ESD for 2030](#)
- [The European Green Deal](#)
- [Regulation \(EU\) 2021/1119 establishing the framework for achieving climate neutrality – European Climate Law](#)
- [Council Recommendation of 16 June 2022 on learning for the green transition and sustainable development \(2022/C 243/01\)](#)
- [Learning for the Green Transition and Sustainable Development](#)

National

- National Development Strategy of the Republic of Croatia until 2030 (in Croatian)
- Low-Carbon Development Strategy of the Republic of Croatia until 2030 with a View to 2050 (in Croatian)
- Climate Change Adaptation Strategy of the Republic of Croatia for the Period up to 2040 with a View to 2070 (in Croatian)
- Updated Integrated National Energy and Climate Plan of the Republic of Croatia for 2021–2030



Institutional and Local

- Development Strategy of the University of Zagreb Faculty of Organization and Informatics 2025–2029 (in Croatian)
- Sustainable Development and Social Responsibility – University of Zagreb Faculty of Organization and Informatics (in Croatian)
- Green and Digital Transformation – University of Zagreb Faculty of Organization and Informatics (in Croatian)
- FOI Green – Recommendations for Responsible Action (in Croatian)
- UN Global Compact – UNIZG FOI Membership and Commitment (in Croatian)



**NOTICE WHAT
IS ALREADY
HAPPENING.**

**EXPLORE WHAT
INTERESTS YOU.**

**THEN TAKE THE
NEXT STEP.**



GET INVOLVED 2

FOI'S GREEN RECOMMENDATIONS

Simple ideas for building on the habits we already have and gradually introducing a few new ones. Small choices matter – especially when they become habits.



Take the stairs

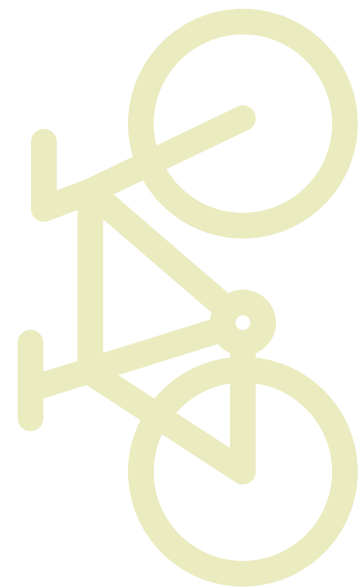


Stairs can do the same job as the lift – but often better. When health and circumstances allow, students and staff members are encouraged to take the stairs as a simple way to use less electricity and add a little movement to the day. The same idea can easily be applied elsewhere too – at home, in student accommodation, at work or in public buildings.

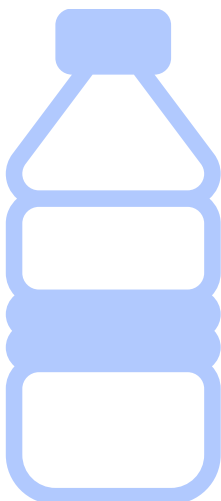
Try it: Choose the stairs for shorter distances whenever possible.

Walk or cycle

For short journeys, walking and cycling can reduce environmental impact and support health and budgets. Varaždin's compact size and cycling infrastructure make these options practical. For nearby trips, local minibuses are available; for longer journeys consider public transport and shared rides. The same approach can support sustainable travel and international mobility.



Walk or cycle to UNIZG FOI and for other short everyday journeys whenever possible.



Choose reusable alternatives

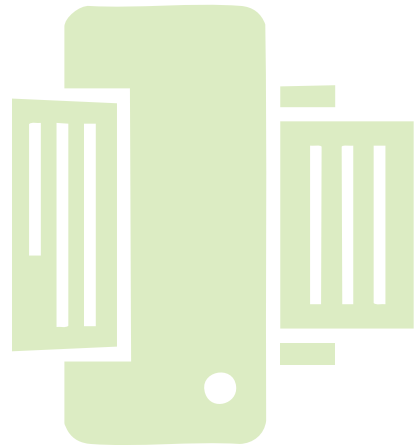
Glass and fabric can replace single-use plastic. Students and staff are encouraged to use reusable bottles, cups, bags, food containers, cutlery and other durable alternatives to single-use products. Prefer items that can be reused, refilled or recycled.

Try it: Replace one disposable item with a reusable alternative.

Think digital before printing

Read, share and submit documents digitally when practical. When printing is necessary, print only what is needed, use both sides, avoid unnecessary colour printing and reuse paper where appropriate.

Try it: Think digital first and print only when a paper copy is really needed.



Separate waste



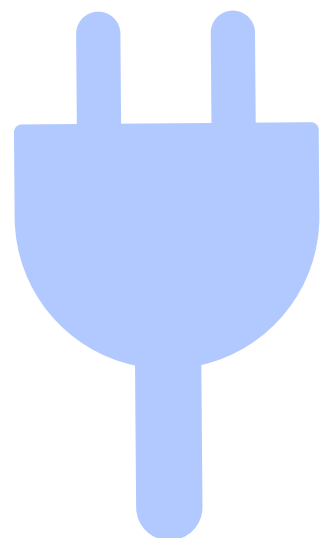
Sorted waste is better than putting everything in one bin. Use FOI's waste-separation points and the correct containers. Continue the habit at home, in accommodation and while travelling. Before discarding an item, consider reuse, repair, donation or repurposing.

Try it: Make waste separation part of everyday life, not only campus life.

Live sustainably

The Student Dormitory in Varaždin demonstrates sustainable infrastructure through solar energy, ecological materials, rainwater use, heat pumps, energy-efficient buildings, solar charging and separate waste collection. In any accommodation, similar principles can be applied by sharing items, separating waste, saving water and energy, limiting unnecessary heating or cooling and planning shared shopping and meals.

Try it: Switch off what is not needed, separate waste, save water and energy, and share or reuse household items.



Buy and consume responsibly



Choose local and seasonal products when possible, buy only what is needed, consider second-hand options, choose durable goods, repair and reuse before replacing, share or borrow rarely used items, and support local producers and businesses. Varaždin's market and second-hand shops offer local examples.

Try it: Before buying something new, consider whether it can be borrowed, repaired, reused or found second-hand.

Be digitally green

Digital activity also uses energy and resources. Reduce digital waste by limiting unnecessary emails and files, cleaning cloud storage, avoiding duplicates, using cameras only when useful, and keeping devices longer. FOI's digital teaching, online-learning and responsible-AI guidance can support these habits.

Try it: Keep digital storage organized and regularly delete what is no longer needed.



Be responsible with food and water

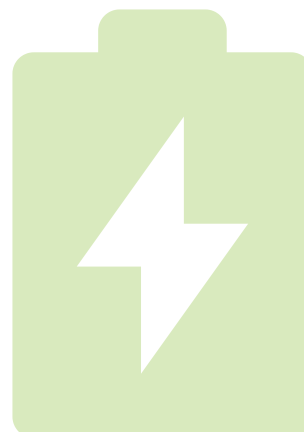
Choose local and seasonal food, plan meals, use leftovers, share food when appropriate, carry a reusable bottle, reduce packaging and use water responsibly. For meetings and events, plan quantities carefully; safe surplus food can be donated or otherwise reused responsibly.

Try it: Buy, prepare or order only as much food as is likely to be eaten.

Use energy responsibly

Save energy alongside using renewable sources: switch off lights and equipment when unnecessary, use daylight, avoid needless standby mode, unplug unused chargers, use heating and cooling responsibly, operate appliances efficiently and run full washing loads where possible.

Try it: Switch off what is not needed and make energy saving part of the routine.



Join activities and learn from others



Go beyond individual habits by joining sustainability events, workshops, projects, competitions, Blended Intensive Programmes, volunteering, humanitarian work, student initiatives, research and intercultural activities. FOI's Centre for Volunteering and Humanitarian Work connects students with community needs at local, national and international levels. Opportunities outside FOI - through local organizations, volunteer groups, city initiatives and home communities - are also valuable.

Try it: Choose something that interests you. Join in. Learn from the experience.

**CHOOSE
SOMETHING
THAT INTERESTS
YOU.**

JOIN IN.

**LEARN FROM
THE EXPERIENCE.**



MAKE A DIFFERENCE

Sustainable habits and participation are important.

Students are also invited to become contributors to change. Useful ideas can come from campus, home, shared accommodation, the city, volunteering, travel, international mobility or experiences in other organizations and communities.

Look for opportunities to reduce unnecessary energy and resource use, improve waste separation, reduce paper or digital waste, support cycling, walking and public transport, reduce food waste, organize events more sustainably, create new green activities or services, or adapt good practices seen elsewhere.



A good idea can start with a very simple observation.

Share ideas and good practices.

Share what you have learned and suggest improvements. Ideas may come from studies, projects, personal experience, mobility, volunteering, work or everyday life. Practices discovered elsewhere can be adapted to FOI, while FOI ideas can inspire others. Some ideas may become small improvements; others may grow into student activities, projects or institutional practices. Connect with FOI staff, institutional services, partner organizations and the wider community when collaboration can help an idea develop.

Make a difference through the SuMoS Green Benchmarking Tool

The SuMoS Green Benchmarking Tool helps students understand the environmental impact of everyday choices and mobility-related behaviour. A short questionnaire covers transport, energy use, waste and sustainable habits; users receive an individual eco score and can compare results with other students.

The tool is intended primarily for students, including those in international mobility programmes, and can also help higher education institutions raise awareness and promote greener mobility. It turns sustainability into something users can measure, compare and act on, helping them identify opportunities for improvement before, during and after mobility.

Measure your impact. Compare your results. Make greener choices.

How sustainable are your everyday choices?

Discover your personal green score with the **SuMoS Green Benchmarking Tool**, compare your results and see where small changes can make a difference. Turn sustainability into action and easily make greener choices in your everyday life and mobility.

**Scan the QR code.
Measure. Compare. Act.**



**SHARE WHAT
YOU HAVE
LEARNED.**

**CONNECT WITH
UNIZG FOI
STAFF.**

ADAPT IT.